



TUMO Labs

Milestone Tracking Guide for Guided Self-Learning

What is a Milestone?

In the Guided Self-Learning (GSL) program at TUMO Labs, you have the flexibility to manage your own time over a 6 to 9-month educational journey. While this freedom is empowering, it requires strict self-management. A milestone is a major checkpoint that marks a significant, completed stage in your learning path.

A milestone is not a passive "to-do" list or a step-by-step reading assignment; it is a fixed point that proves you are actively creating value. You decide *how* you get there, but you must clearly define *what* you will deliver.

Description and Structure

To ensure you do not fall into the "Illusion of Planning" (waiting until the last minute), the program is broken down into manageable **2-month cycles**. At the beginning of every cycle, you must define and submit your plan.

You are not limited to a single milestone; you may set multiple milestones for a 2-month cycle based on your capacity. Furthermore, these milestones do not have to be strictly technical. They can encompass your core technical learning, soft skills development, teamwork, or other educational blocks applicable within the TUMO Labs ecosystem.

Instead of listing every single micro-step you will take, we use a professional, results-oriented framework: **Milestone + KPI**.

- **Milestone (The Objective):** What specific stage of your project or skill development will be completed at the end of the 2-month cycle?
- **KPI (Key Performance Indicator):** What is the exact, tangible artifact that proves this milestone is achieved?

The SMART Framework & Prohibited Verbs

When formulating your milestone and KPI, words like *read*, *study*, *understand*, or *familiarize* are **strictly prohibited** because they cannot be measured. Instead, use active, project-based verbs like *build*, *write*, *code*, *design*, *test*, or *present*.

Before submitting, run your KPI through the SMART filter:

- **Specific:** Exactly what will you build, solve, or present?
- **Measurable:** Is the artifact tangible (e.g., a GitHub link, a design file, a presentation, a video)?
- **Achievable:** Is this realistic to complete within 60 days?
- **Relevant:** Does this directly contribute to your GSL track or soft skills growth?
- **Time-bound:** Your strict deadline is the end of the 2-month cycle.

Examples of Good and Bad Milestones

-  **Bad (Abstract & Passive):**
 - **Milestone 1:** Study Python and improve communication skills.
 - **KPI:** Read 3 tutorials and feel confident about talking to the team. (*Why it fails: "Study" and "feel confident" are not measurable. There is no proof of work.*)
-  **Good (SMART & Actionable):**
 - **Milestone 1:** Backend setup and technical presentation.
 - **KPI:** A working Python script that scrapes target data stored in a database (GitHub link), and a slide deck presented to the team explaining the architecture. (*Why it works: Clear objectives, specific artifacts, measurable results covering both hard and soft skills.*)

Steps to Create and Submit Your Milestone

Step 1: Drafting After the introductory workshop, you have one week to independently draft your Milestone(s) and KPI(s) for the upcoming 2 months.

Step 2: Submission via Google Form Open the provided official Google Form link and fill in the required fields: Milestone Name, KPI (Artifact Definition), and Deadline.

Step 3: The 15-Minute Approval Call Book a 15-minute 1-on-1 online meeting with the GSL Team via Calendly.

- **Purpose:** This call is to "stress test" your KPI, making sure your workload is realistic for a 60-day period and your result is actually measurable.
- **Outcome:** Once approved, your 2-month cycle officially begins.

Step 4: The End-of-Cycle Group Defense At the end of the two months, you will participate in a group defense session alongside your peers.

- **Your Turn:** You will present your milestone(s), demonstrate your completed artifacts (KPIs), and participate in a Q&A session.
- **Peer Learning:** You will observe other students' projects and provide feedback, learning from their problem-solving approaches and challenges.

Student Responsibilities

- **Ownership:** You are the Project Manager of your education. It is your responsibility to meet the deadlines and deliver the KPI.
- **Attendance:** Missing the 15-minute approval call or the bi-monthly group defense without prior notice will result in an incomplete cycle.